

CS-338 Intro to the Theory of Computation

- Lecture #14

➤ **Complexity Theory: NP Completeness**

- Prof Pietro S. Oliveto

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Southern University of Science and Technology (SUSTech)

- `olivetop@sustech.edu.cn`
<https://faculty.sustech.edu.cn/olivetop>
- Office: Room 113

Overview

Last time:

- $\text{NTIME}(t(n))$, NP
- $\text{HAMPATH}, \text{COMPOSITES}, \text{CLIQUE}, \text{SUBSET} - \text{SUM} \in \text{NP}$
- $\text{COMPOSITES}, \text{PRIMES} \in P$
- $\text{PRIMES} \in \text{coNP}$
- P vs NP problem

Today: (Sipser §7.5)

- Polynomial-time reducibility
- NP-completeness

Quick Review

NP = All languages where can verify membership quickly

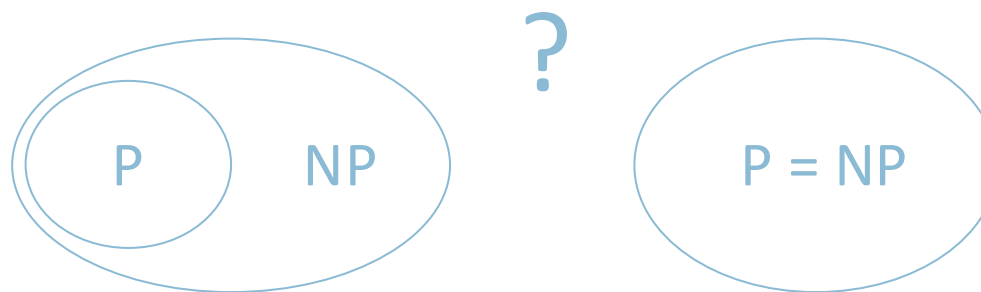
P = All languages where can test membership quickly

P versus NP question: Does $P = NP$?

$SAT = \{\langle \phi \rangle \mid \phi \text{ is a satisfiable Boolean formula}\}$

Cook-Levin Theorem: $SAT \in P \rightarrow P = NP$

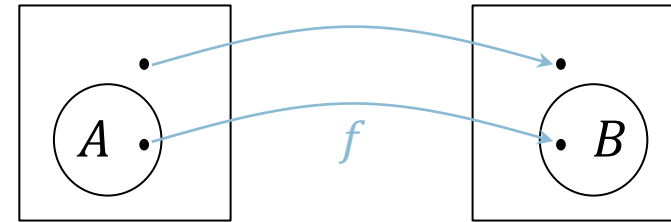
Proof plan: Show that every $A \in NP$ is polynomial time reducible to SAT .



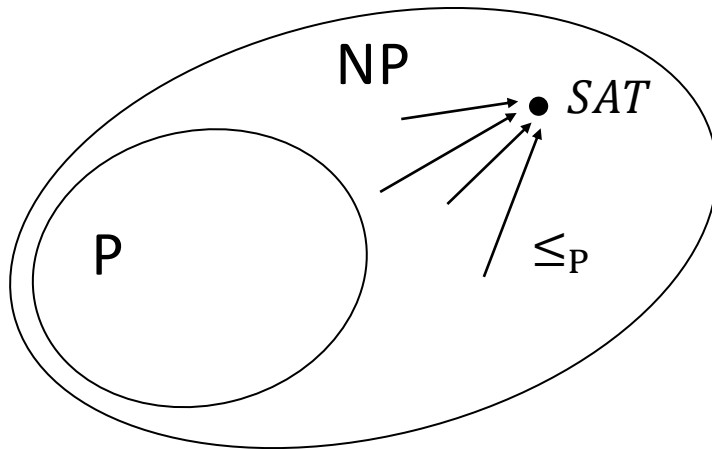
Polynomial Time Reducibility

Defn: A is polynomial time reducible to B ($A \leq_P B$) if $A \leq_m B$ by a reduction function that is computable in polynomial time.

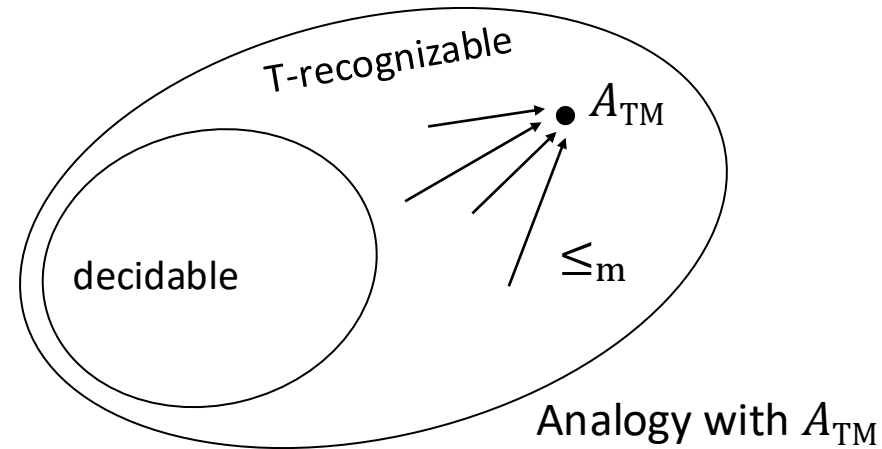
Theorem: If $A \leq_P B$ and $B \in P$ then $A \in P$.



f is computable in polynomial time



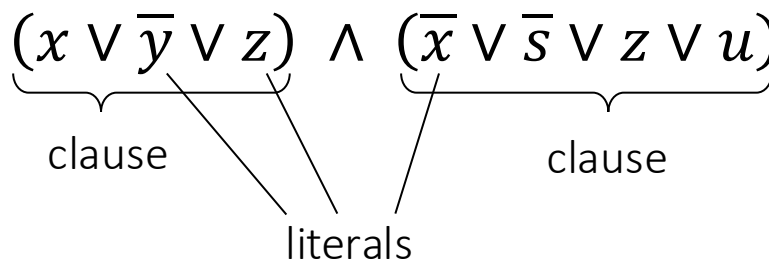
Idea to show $SAT \in P \rightarrow P = NP$



Analogy with A_{TM}

$\leq_P$ Example: $3SAT$ and $CLIQUE$

Defn: A Boolean formula ϕ is in Conjunctive Normal Form (CNF) if it has the form $\phi = (x \vee \bar{y} \vee z) \wedge (\bar{x} \vee \bar{s} \vee z \vee u) \wedge \cdots \wedge (\bar{z} \vee \bar{u})$



Literal: a variable or a negated variable

Clause: an OR ($\vee$) of literals.

CNF: an AND ($\wedge$) of clauses.

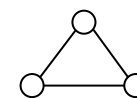
3CNF: a CNF with exactly 3 literals in each clause.

$3SAT = \{\langle \phi \rangle \mid \phi \text{ is a satisfiable 3CNF formula}\}$

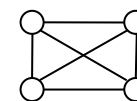
Defn: A k -clique in a graph is a subset of k nodes all directly connected by edges.

$CLIQUE = \{\langle G, k \rangle \mid \text{graph } G \text{ contains a } k\text{-clique}\}$

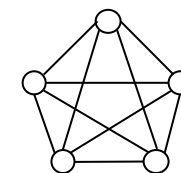
Will show: $3SAT \leq_P CLIQUE$



3-clique



4-clique



5-clique

$3SAT \leq_P CLIQUE$

Theorem: $3SAT \leq_P CLIQUE$

Proof: Give polynomial-time reduction f that maps ϕ to G, k where ϕ is satisfiable iff G has a k -clique.

A satisfying assignment to a CNF formula has ≥ 1 true literal in each clause.

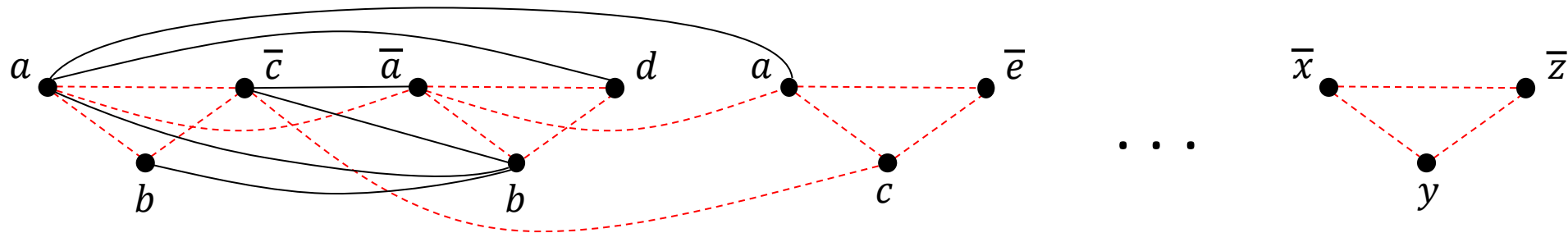
$$\phi = (a \vee b \vee \bar{c}) \wedge (\bar{a} \vee b \vee d) \wedge (a \vee c \vee \bar{e}) \wedge \cdots \wedge (\bar{x} \vee y \vee \bar{z})$$

$f \downarrow$

G
 k

$=$

$= \# \text{ clauses}$



Forbidden edges:

- 1) within a clause
- 2) inconsistent labels (a and $\bar{a}$)

G has all non-forbidden edges

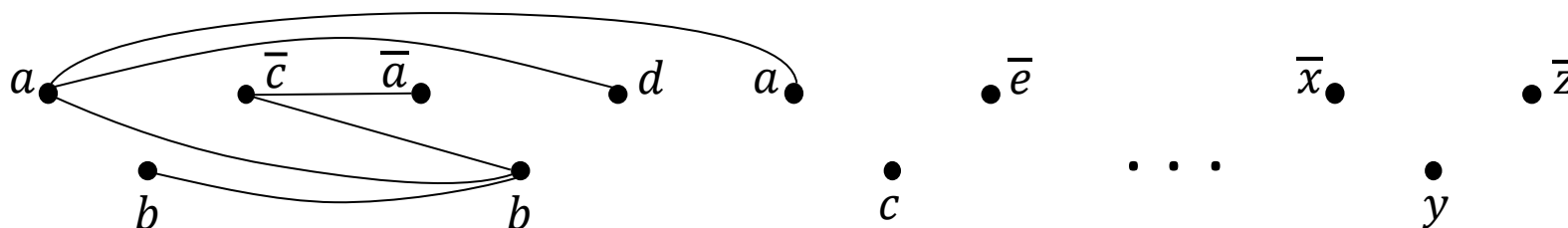
$3SAT \leq_P CLIQUE$ conclusion

$$\phi = (a \vee b \vee \bar{c}) \wedge (\bar{a} \vee b \vee d) \wedge (a \vee c \vee \bar{e}) \wedge \dots \wedge (\bar{x} \vee y \vee \bar{z})$$

$f \downarrow$

G
 k

$=$
 $= \# \text{ clauses}$



Claim: ϕ is satisfiable iff G has a k -clique

($\rightarrow$) Take any satisfying assignment to ϕ . Pick 1 true literal in each clause.

The corresponding nodes in G are a k -clique because they don't have forbidden edges.

($\leftarrow$) Take any k -clique in G . It must have 1 node in each clause.

Set each corresponding literal TRUE. That gives a satisfying assignment to ϕ .

The reduction f is computable in polynomial time.

Corollary: $CLIQUE \in P \rightarrow 3SAT \in P$

Check-in 15.1

Does this proof require 3 literals per clause?

- (a) Yes, to prove the claim.
- (b) Yes, to show it is in poly time.
- (c) No, it works for any size clauses.

NP-completeness

Defn: B is NP-complete if

- 1) $B \in \text{NP}$
- 2) For all $A \in \text{NP}$, $A \leq_P B$

If B is NP-complete and $B \in \text{P}$ then $\text{P} = \text{NP}$.

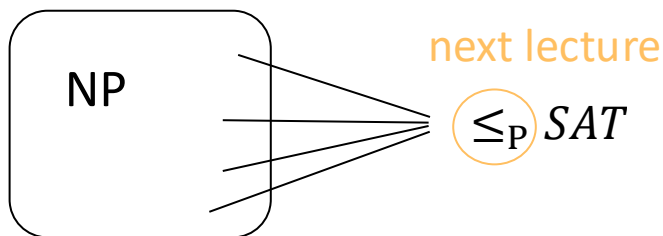
Cook-Levin Theorem: SAT is NP-complete

Proof: Next lecture; assume true

Check-in 15.2

What language that we've previously seen is most analogous to SAT ?

- (a) A_{TM}
- (b) E_{TM}
- (c) $\{0^k 1^k \mid k \geq 0\}$



today $\leq_P \text{HAMPATH}$

To show some language C is NP-complete, show $3\text{SAT} \leq_P C$.

or some other previously shown NP-complete language

HAMPATH is NP-complete

Theorem: *HAMPATH* is NP-complete

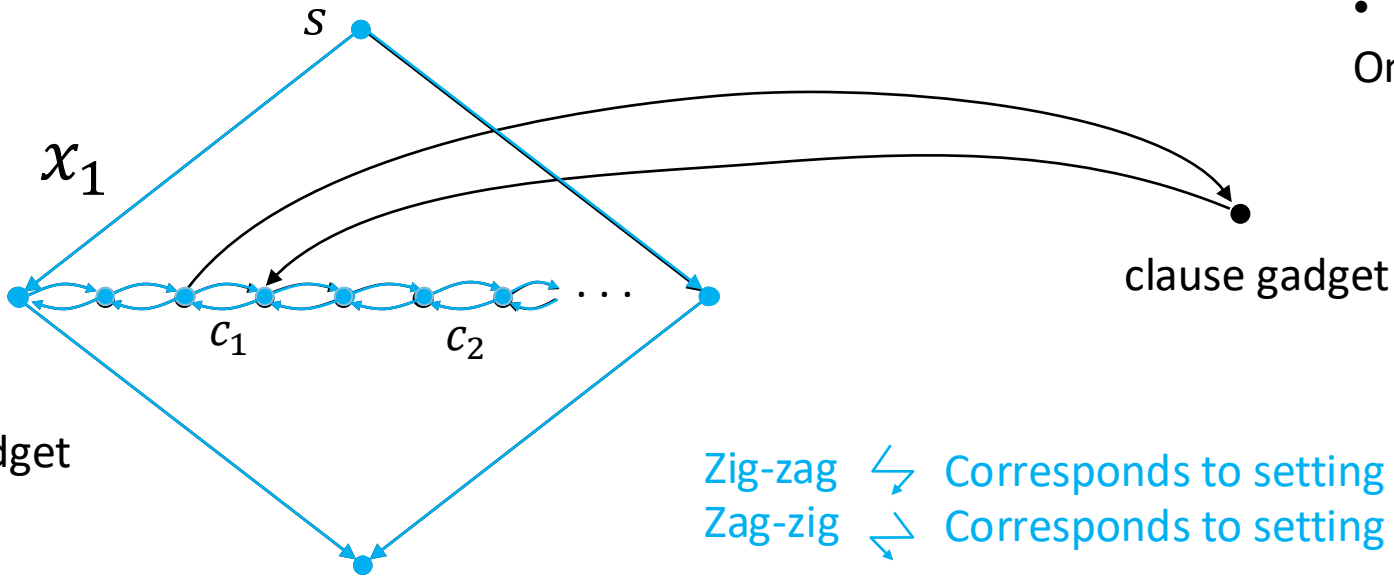
Proof: Show $3SAT \leq_p HAMPATH$ (assumes $3SAT$ is NP-complete)

Idea: “Simulate” variables and clauses with “gadgets”

$$\phi = (x_1 \vee \bar{x}_2 \vee x_3) \wedge (\bar{x}_1 \vee x_2 \vee x_4) \wedge \dots \wedge ($$

$f \downarrow$

$\langle G, s, t \rangle$

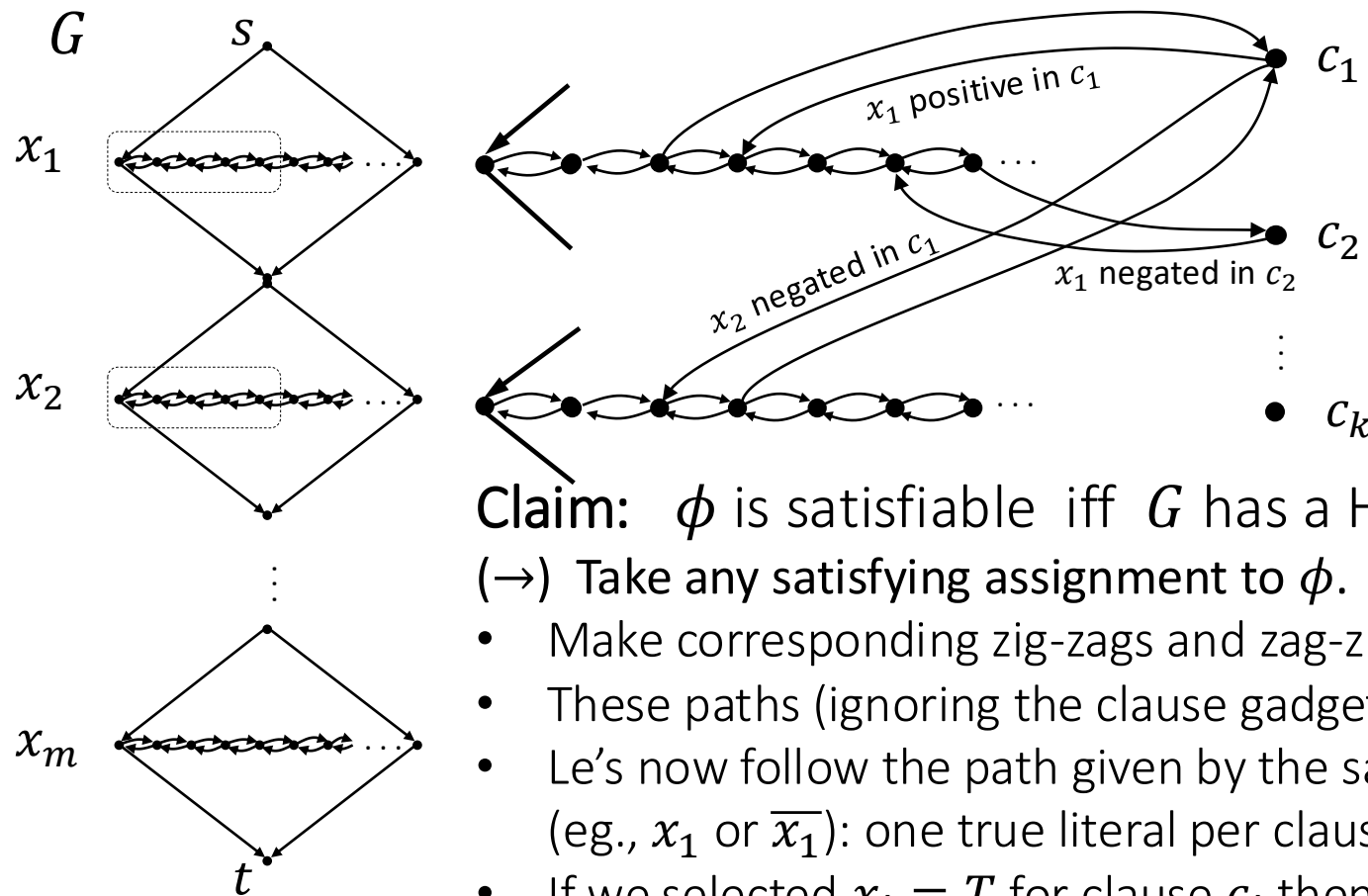


For each variable gadget:

- Let k be the number of clauses
 - Horizontal row contains $3k + 1$ nodes + the two endpoints
 - one pair for each clause + a separator
- One clause gadget per clause (one node)

Construction of G

$$\phi = \underbrace{(x_1 \vee \bar{x}_2 \vee x_3)}_{c_1} \wedge \underbrace{(\bar{x}_1 \vee x_2 \vee x_4)}_{c_2} \wedge \cdots \wedge \underbrace{(\quad x_m \quad)}_{c_k}$$



m variables
 k clauses

The reduction f is computable
in polynomial time.

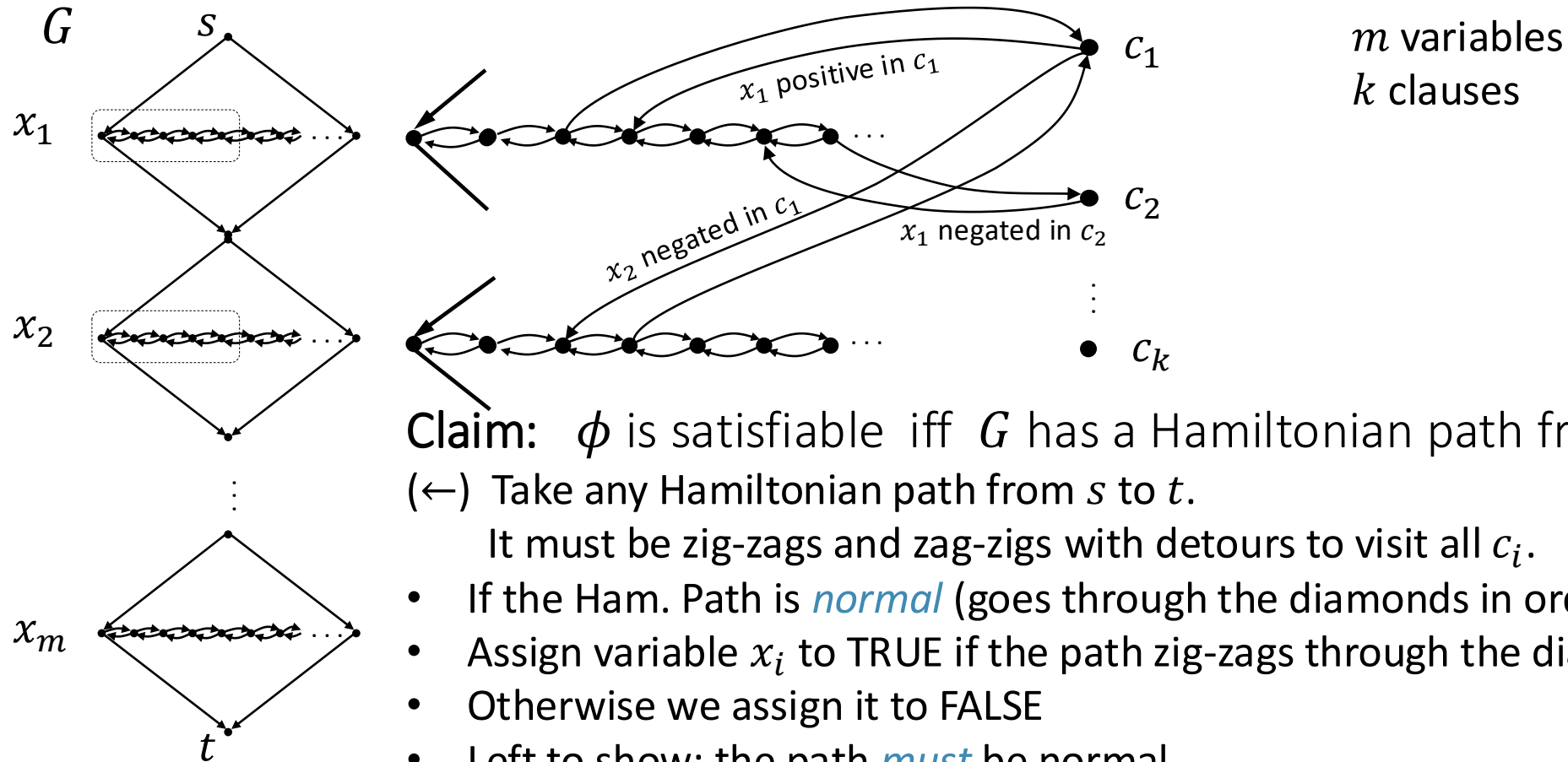
Claim: ϕ is satisfiable iff G has a Hamiltonian path from s to t .

($\rightarrow$) Take any satisfying assignment to ϕ .

- Make corresponding zig-zags and zag-zigs through variable gadgets from s to t .
- These paths (ignoring the clause gadgets) all would be Hamiltonian (there are many)
- Let's now follow the path given by the satisfying assignment (selecting the true literals (eg., x_1 or $\bar{x}_1$): one true literal per clause
- If we selected $x_i = T$ for clause c_j then we can detour through c_j with a zig-zag
- Otherwise ($\bar{x}_1 = T$) we can detour through c_j with a zag-zig
- If several literals in a clause are True, only one option is taken

Construction of G

$$\phi = \underbrace{(x_1 \vee \bar{x}_2 \vee x_3)}_{c_1} \wedge \underbrace{(\bar{x}_1 \vee x_2 \vee x_4)}_{c_2} \wedge \cdots \wedge \underbrace{(\quad x_m \quad)}_{c_k}$$



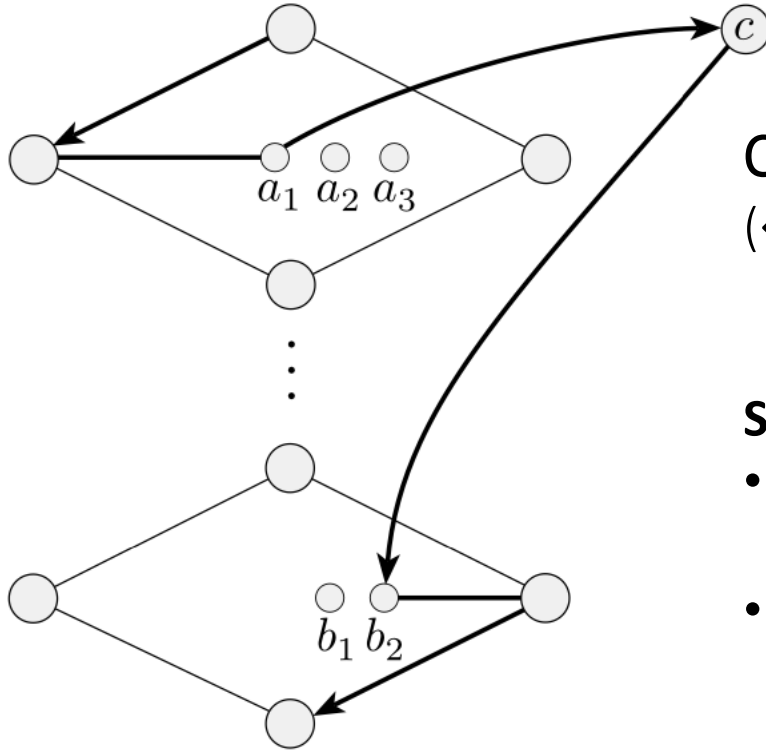
Claim: ϕ is satisfiable iff G has a Hamiltonian path from s to t .

($\leftarrow$) Take any Hamiltonian path from s to t .

It must be zig-zags and zag-zigs with detours to visit all c_i .

- If the Ham. Path is *normal* (goes through the diamonds in order) then it's easy
- Assign variable x_i to TRUE if the path zig-zags through the diamond
- Otherwise we assign it to FALSE
- Left to show: the path *must* be normal

Hamiltonian construction path must be normal



Claim: ϕ is satisfiable iff G has a Hamiltonian path from s to t .

($\leftarrow$) Take any Hamiltonian path from s to t .

Show it must be **zig-zags** and **zag-zigs** with detours to visit all c_i .

Get corresponding truth asst. It must satisfy ϕ because path visits all c_i .

Show the path is normal

- It fails normality if it enters a clause from one diamond (a_1) and exits into another diamond (b_2)
- Then either a_2 or a_3 is a separator node
 - **a_2 separator:** the only edges entering a_2 are a_1 and a_3 : you can't get to a_2 without hitting a_1 again $\Rightarrow$ Path not Hamiltonian
 - **a_3 separator:** then a_1 and a_2 are the same clause pair: you can't get to a_2 without going through a_1 or c
- Thus the path must be normal

Quick review of today

1. NP-completeness
2. SAT and $3SAT$
3. $3SAT \leq_P HAMPATH$
4. $3SAT \leq_P CLIQUE$
5. Strategy for proving NP-completeness:
Reduce from $3SAT$ by constructing gadgets
that simulate variables and clauses.